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January 10, 1975
SUPERSEDING
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INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

MOP, WET, COTTON, CELLULOSE COATED

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington, DC 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers cellulose coated cotton yarn mopheads for wet floor use.

1.2 Classification. The mopheads shall be of two sizes.

Size 1 12 Ounce
Size 2 24 Ounce

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bid, or request for proposal, form a part of this specification, to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

V-T-276 - Thread, Cotton.
V-T-285 - Thread, Polyester
V-T-295 - Thread, Nylon.
QQ-S-781 - Steel, Strapping, Flat.
UU-P-268 - Paper, Kraft, Untreated, Wrapping.
CCC-C-426 - Cloth, Drill, Cotton.
CCC-C-429 - Cloth, Osnaburg, Cotton.
CCC-C-467 - Cloth, Burlap, Jute, (Or Kenaf).
PPP-B-636 - Box, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-T-45 - Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced and Plain, For Sealing and Securing.
PPP-T-97 - Tape, Pressure-Sensitive, Adhesive, Filament Reinforced.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 751 - Stitches, Seams, and Stitching.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specification, Standards and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-B-3149 - Baling of Clothing and Equipage.

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, NW, Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample approval. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1) before production is commenced, a sample of the mop to be supplied shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for examination and approval in accordance with 4.2. Approval of the preproduction sample authorizes commencement of production, but does not relieve the supplier of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The preproduction sample shall be manufactured in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production items.

3.2 Materials.

3.2.1 Yarn for mophead. The yarn used in the mophead shall be a continuous filamentary structure consisting of a core of multiply cotton yarn and a coating of cellulose completely surrounding the cotton core along its entire length and periphery. The cotton core shall be any suitable construction which will maintain the requirements of the finished yarn called for in this specification and as outlined in Table I.

TABLE I. Physical requirements

Size	Weight Ounces Minimum	No. Strands Per Mop Minimum	Width At Center In Inches		*Strand Length In Inches Minimum		Strand Diameter Inches Minimum	Minimum Tensile Strength
			Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.		
1	12	112	5-3/4	6-1/4	29	34	0.24	15 Pounds
2	24	168	6-1/2	7	38	44	0.24	15 Pounds

*Length is cut length of strands before folding at center binding.

3.2.1.1 Water absorption. Each size mop shall have a minimum water absorption of 700 percent when tested as specified in paragraph 4.4.2.

3.2.2 Thread, sewing.

3.2.2.1 Cotton sewing thread when used shall be type 1 A2, ticket number 40 of V-T-276.

3.2.2.2 Nylon sewing thread when used shall be of a natural color, and in accordance with type II, letter size FF, class 1 of V-T-295.

3.2.2.3 Polyester sewing thread when used shall be of a natural color, and in accordance with Type I, letter size FF of V-T-285.

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3.2.3 Cloth, headbands. The finished headbands for all sizes of mopheads covered by this specification may be in woven tape form or cut strips of cloth 6-1/4 inches in width ± 1/4 inch. Edges of the band shall be woven, shall have a selvage, or if having cut edges, shall be turned under, securely stitched with a 1/8 inch stitching gauge using nylon, polyester, or cotton sewing thread, 3.2.2. All headbands shall be cotton drill meeting the requirements of type I, II or III, class 1 or 2 of CCC-C-426, except that the cloth may contain nylon fiber. All headbands shall be one piece.

3.3 Construction.

3.3.1 Illustration. The illustration shown in figure 1, is for the purpose of illustrating general design and is not to preclude the purchase of items which are otherwise in accordance with the requirements of this specification.

3.3.2 All sizes of mopheads covered by this specification shall have a headband, 3.2.3, encircle the middle of the evenly distributed mop yarns and overlap at least two inches. The yarns and headband shall be securely sewed together with sewing thread, 3.2.2, using stitch type 301 or 401 of Federal Standard No. 751. There shall be six parallel rows of stitching in equally spaced sets of two rows each; one set along each edge of the band and one set in the center of the band. Outer rows of stitching shall be 1/8 to 1/2 inch from the edge of the band. Each row of stitching shall have not less than 5 stitches per inch.

3.4 Workmanship. The finished mopheads shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. Mopheads shall be free from defects which may effect their durability, serviceability or appearance. The concurrence of defects shall not exceed the levels set by the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplied and services conform to the prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preproduction sample inspection. The preproduction sample shall be examined for defects in 4.3.2.

4.3 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.3.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used are manufactured, tested, and inspected to insure conformance with the requirements of this specification.

4.3.2 End item inspection. Examination of the end item shall be in accordance with the classification of defects, inspection levels and acceptable quality levels set forth below. The lot size for the purpose of determining the sample size in accordance with MIL-STD-105, shall be expressed in units of mopheads for inspection under 4.3.2.1.

4.3.2.1 Visual examination of the end item for defects in appearance, construction, dimension, and workmanship. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 2.5 defects per one hundred units. The sample unit for this examination shall be one mophead.

TABLE II. Visual and dimensional examination

Examine	Defects
Material	
Mophead yarns	Yarn ends not cut squarely. Yarn not properly coated with cellulose.
Thread, sewing	Not thread specified herein.
Headband	Not made from material specified herein or not made in manner specified herein.
Construction	
Mophead yarns	Yarns not evenly distributed across width of mophead. Less than minimum of yarns in mophead.

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TABLE II. Visual and dimensional examination (con.)

Examine	Defects
Headband	Less than minimum required width. More than maximum allowed width. Overlap less than two inches.

4.3.2.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing and marking as required by section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored as specified in table III. The sample shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall consist of the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE III. Classification of preparation for defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling, distortion of container.
Contents (exterior container)	Number per container is more or less than required. Net weight exceeds requirements.

4.3.3 Testing end items. The end item shall be tested for the applicable characteristics as specified in 4.4. Sample size shall be in accordance with level S-2, and randomly selected from the lot. Sample unit shall be one mophead. Lot size shall be the number of mopheads of the same size. No two sample mopheads shall be taken from the same package. The lot shall be rejected if more than one sample unit, or the average all sample units, falls below the minimum requirements in 3.2.1.1.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Breaking strength. Breaking strength tests shall be made in a pendulum-type machine having smooth grips of the drum type not less than 1-1/4 inches in diameter. The pulling drum shall travel at a rate of 12 inches per minute ± 2 inches. The test span shall be 10 inches between drum contacts. If specimen breaks less than 1/2 inch from point of contact with drum, the result shall be disregarded. At least 10 results shall be averaged. Tests shall be made at prevailing conditions except in settlement of disputes when product to be tested shall be conditioned at 65 percent plus or minus 2 percent relative humidity at 70 degrees plus or minus 2 degrees F. for not less than 16 hours. The lot shall be rejected if more than one sample unit, or the average of all sample units, falls below the minimum tensile strength required in table I.

4.4.2 Water absorption. Twenty-eight strands, each 10 inches in length shall be cut from each test mop and washed in warm water (40 degrees ± 3 degrees C.) three times. The strands shall be squeezed by hand at least ten times while in the water during each washing. The twenty-eight strands shall be laid out their full length and loosely tied together in the middle with one strand of nylon sewing thread specified in paragraph 3.2.2.2. Attach an easily removable non-corrosive metal sinker weight to the nylon thread. Fill a two liter beaker with sufficient distilled water, maintanied at 26 degrees C plus or minus 2 degrees, to provide a two inch head above the submerged strands. Immerse the tied strands touching the bottom of the beaker for exactly two minutes. Remove from the water, and holding by the nylon thread or sinker, allow the strands to drain for exactly 50 seconds. Immediately place the strands without sinker in a covered container that has been weighed to the nearest 0.1 gram. Weigh and subtract the tare of the container to find the wet weight of the strands. Dry the strands to constant weight at 105 degrees C. Calculate % water absorption using the formula:

$$\% \text{ Water Absorption} = \frac{A - B}{B} \times 100$$

A - Weight of strands wet
B - Weight of strands dried

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5. *PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY*

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. Thirty-six mopheads of like description, in bundles of twelve each, shall be tied together in the following manner: (a) Twelve mopheads shall be tied together flat, at the top, center, and bottom in each bundle reversing the heads and ends of the mopheads in sets of four each. (b) Thirty-six mopheads, tied together as specified, shall be laid side by side and further tied together as close to the ends as possible with cord or twine.

5.1.2 Level B, civil agencies. Twelve mopheads of like description in sets of 3 or 4 with reversed heads and ends shall be tied together at the top and bottom with cord or twine.

5.1.3 Level C. Mopheads shall be packaged in accordance with the industry's practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Each bundle of 36 mopheads of like description packaged as specified in 5.1.1 shall be wrapped in two sheets of 40 pounds minimum basis weight kraft paper conforming to grade B of UU-P-268. Each wrap shall be sealed with a 3 inch width gummed paper tape conforming to class 3 of PPP-T-45. Each wrap bundle shall be reinforced with one 5/8 by 0.020 inch flat steel strap conforming to type I, class A of QQ-S-781 or a 3/4 inch width tape band conforming to type II of PPP-T-97, covering the taped folded ends of the kraft wrapped. Two bundles, paper wrapped and strapped or banded as specified, shall then be packed in a cotton osnaburg cloth bag conforming to type I, class 2, finish A of CCC-C-429 or in a jute (or kenaf) burlap cloth bag conforming to class 1 of CCC-C-467. The bag shall have one sewn end and one open end securely wire-tied and sewn in accordance with MIL-B-3149.

5.2.2 Level B, civil agencies. Six bundles of the 12 ounce or three bundles of the 24 ounce mopheads shall be packed in a close fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The inside of each box shall be fitted with a taped fiberboard liner conforming to type CF, class domestic, variety SW, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The mopheads shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest rates, in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipments shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, shipments shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Sizes (see 1.2).
(c) When preproduction sample is required (see 3.1).
(d) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing.

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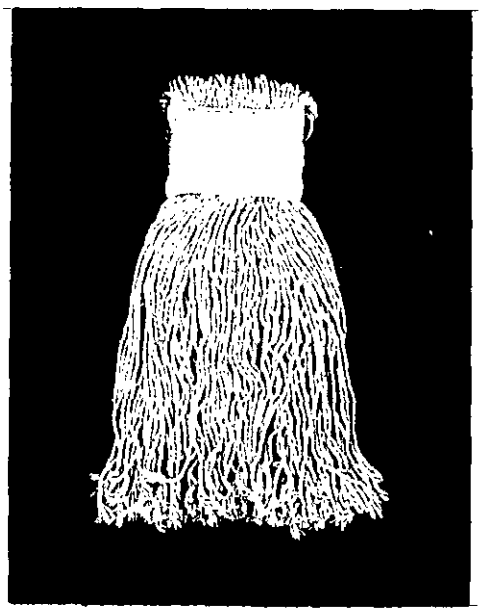


FIGURE 1

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